

Please complete the following before next Thursday's class. You will be discussing your answers with your peers.

Strengths

Assignment: Briefly describe two strengths you have related to applied mathematics or statistics analysis and data projects. Some examples (but many other things are possible) are a technical skill, an interpersonal skill, or a communication skill.

Rationale: When beginning with a project, it is an advantage to know possible skills you are bringing to a team. This can help establish your competency with a client, but recognizing a strength that applies to a project can also give you confidence in your ability to complete the work (as well as give a more accurate timeline). It can also be quite uncomfortable to talk about your strengths – so let's start practicing now. Contrary to this, though, it can also cause you to depend on your best skills too much and bias your judgement of the best approach.

In class: you will practice (i) how to demonstrate your strengths to a client and establish your credibility, and (ii) discuss a few biases your strengths could cause in your approach

Growth Opportunities

Assignment: Briefly describe two areas or skills for which you have room to improve

Rationale: In consulting or collaboration, no one person can have all the skills needed to complete the work. Thus, it is good to do an honest inventory of areas where you could improve before starting a project. It is important to not promise something you can't do or do in the desired timeline. On the other hand, it is just as important to continually be developing skills to overcome your limitations. These opportunities exist in almost every project, and with planning and awareness you can set yourself up to learn and overcome limitations

*In class :*you will practice (i) communicating a limitation in a way that wouldn't undermine your credibility on a project, (ii) communicating concrete evidence that you can overcome a limitation, and (iii) communication a limitation that you need help overcoming.

Skills you want to Develop

Assignment: Briefly describe two skills you want to develop through this class and your consulting project. Create a brief plan for developing these skills this semester.

Rationale: This class is a time for you to learn and develop consulting and other related skills. Let's make a plan in advance for how you can do this. One framework you can use is the following:



S	Specific	What will be accomplished? What actions will you take?
M	Measurable	What data will measure the goal? (How much? How well?)
A	Achievable	Is the goal doable? Do you have the necessary skills and resources?
R	Relevant	How does the goal align with broader goals? Why is the result important?
T	Time-Bound	What is the time frame for accomplishing the goal?

More details are available at: https://www.ucop.edu/local-human-resources/_files/performance-appraisal/How%20to%20write%20SMART%20Goals%20v2.pdf

In class: You will explain both the skill and your plan to develop it with your peers to receive their feedback and ideas – especially if your skill is too vague or your plan isn't realistic or likely to succeed.